8) The principle of public trust and accountability.

Four Distinct Phases- Financial Administrative History of India

Period I (1765-1858) - Creation of structure and concretisation.

Period II (1860-1919) - Development of systems and Procedures.

Period III (1919-1947) - Democratisation and Decentralisation

Period IV (1950-till date) - Development orientation.

New Emerging Trends - Financial Administration in India

1) Regulation and control of fiscal deficit
2) Cutback on non-development expenditure
3) Development of zero base perspective
4) De-emphasised public sector
5) Non-bureaucratic delivery of public goods and services
6) Focus on decentralized responsibility for financing development plans
7) Towards deregulation and liberalization

6.6.1 Enactment and Execution of Budget

Budgetary Cycle

In order to allow time for the executive and legislative processes to go through, budgeting is geared to a cycle. The process of approval is very significant in are possible form of government.

The cycle consists of four phases:

Preparation and submission;
Approval;
Execution; and Audit

At any given point of time, several cycles would be in operation and would be over lapping. Nevertheless, various segments of a cycle have different operational life.

Budget Preparation

In India, budget preparation formally begins on the receipt of a circular from the Ministry of Finance sometime during September/October, that is, about six months before the budget presentation. The circular prescribes the time-schedule for sending final estimates separately for plan and non-plan, and the guidelines to be followed in the examination of budget estimates to be prepared by the department concerned. The general rule is that the person who spends money should also prepare the budget estimates. Budget proposals normally contain the following information:

i) Accounts classification
ii) Budget estimates of the current year
iii) Revised estimates of the current year
iv) Actuals for the previous year; and
V) Proposed estimates for the next financial year.

Financial Year

When the first modern budget was presented in 1860, the financial year adopted by the government was from 1st May to 30th April. Beginning with the year 1866, however, the financial year was changed to 1st April to 31stMarch, in conformity with the practice in England.

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